The Elton Ravo Prize

26

BDT 2003 · La Manga

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

One of the tour “trophies” is the Elton Ravo Prize, but where did it all begin? Fortunately, Ash preserved the memory of a seminal moment in tour history, writing the following Tour Tail many years ago.



ASH

“One of the great tour highlights for me was watching the dedication with which Ravo set about learning the words to what is now the official tour anthem, "Your Song". Quite where Ravo got the idea from that he could sing is a mystery but that has never stopped him performing the Elton classic at every opportunity since that famous first performance in La Manga. In my mind, the funniest moment of any tour to date and well worth a trip down memory lane.



The Dogs in the aftermath of the Elton Ravo moment!

In those days the tour was a week long, which meant six consecutive nights on it and plenty of time to fill during the day. Monkey decided to have 6 all dayers. Bald dog attempted to enter the Guinness Book of Records for the most Quick Crafties in a day, and Ravo decided to learn the words to Your Song in preparation for a grand finale in the piano bar on the final night.

The difficulty was that the only words Ravo had in his vocabulary that week were "dog", "schmoker", and "schmoker dog", none of which featured in the lyrics to Your Song. Together with the effects of 16 Stella Miguels and the kitty master antics of Monkey dog, this made life very difficult for the aspiring crooner, who for three days could only remember the lines "It's a little bit funny!" and "I hope you schmoke mine!".

By day five, no one thought it was a little bit funny as Ravo sang these lines over and over again until the dogs were begging him to go back to talking about how he had schmoked his schmoker into the schmokey schmoke in the first round.

But gradually, he cracked it and delivered a beautiful rendition around the pool. Elton Ravo was all set for his big performance.

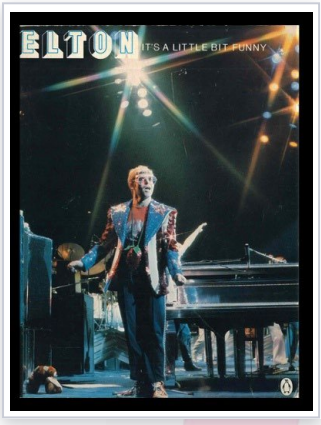


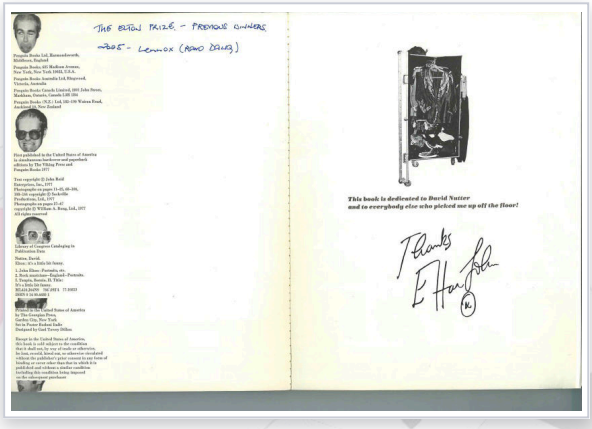
The Piano Bar, La Manga!

By about 10pm on the last night, 12 exhausted dogs wiped away their beer sweats and swept aside their end of tour demons to gather in the piano bar for one last round of vodka red bulls in anticipation of the big performance.

> Needless to say, when Ravo approached the pianist Brian and slurred something along the lines of "Do you mind if I have a go on your schmoker and schmoke a few lines of Your Song?", he wasn't overenthusiastic and neither were the group of retired golfers and families gathered around the piano for a relaxing evening. But eventually, just to shut Ravo up, Brian gave in.
>
> So excited was Ravo that no sooner had Brian knocked out the first couple of notes of the intro, he was already onto the chorus, prompting Brian to start again and warn Ravo that the next attempt would be "his last chance". Unfortunately, the other 11 dogs were crying so much with laughter by this stage that no one thought to capture the moment on camera so only those lucky enough to be there will remember just how good the next few minutes were. The Elton Ravo prize had been born."

The following year on BDT 2004, Ravo turned up on tour with an Elton book, signed by the great man himself and announced that he was creating a new trophy, the "Elton Ravo Prize", to be awarded to the Dog who provided the most memorable Karaoke performance on each tour which he, of course, successfully defended that year! The list of winners is set out below.







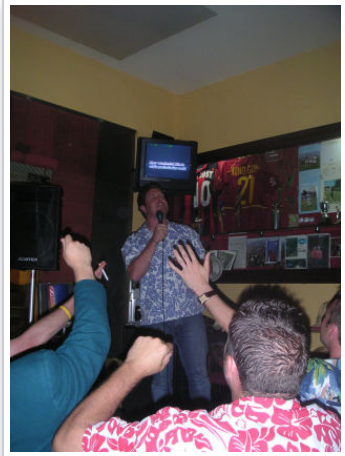
The Elton Ravo Prize

Table of the Elton Ravos!

YEAR	WINNER	SONG
2002	N/A	N/A
2003	N/A	N/A
2004	Ravo	I Hope You Schmoke Mine
2005	Little	Red Red Love
2006	Purlo	Ticket To Ride
2007	Langrish	The Littlest Hobo
2008	Boysie	Suspicious Minds
2009	Boggy	The Way To San Lorenzo
2010	Boggy	Hey Hey He's A Monkey
2011	Boggy	Ocean Drive
2012	Little	Red Red Love
2013	Boysie	Rocky Theme Tune
2014	Ollie	Redemption Song

YEAR	WINNER	SONG
2015	Rufus	Carefree
2016	BT & Rufus	Suspicious Minds
2017	BT, Adam G & Hursty	Candle In The Wind
2018	Fred	La Marseillaise
2019	BT	With Or Without You
2020	BT	Push It!
2021	Adam T	The Drugs Don't Work
2022	Kezza	You Are Always On My Mind
2023	Hulmey	Another Brick In The Wall
2024	Boysie	Na Na Na Na Na Na Na
2025	Adam T	Macho Man
2026	Charlie	Gold

Highlighted row added after BDT 2026 in Scottsdale







Some Elton Ravo Performances

What is the greatest karaoke performance in tour history? There have been many but for quality and, trust me, it pains me to say this, BT's spontaneous duet of With Or Without You in a Paphos bar on BDT 2019 did bring the house down.

For pure humour, Ravo's performance of "Your Song" on BDT 2003 and Purlo's "Ticket To Ride" on BDT 2006 take some beating, whilst it is always good value to have 24 lads belting out "Red Red Love" or "Whoooaa Sometimes I Get Gav Neilan"! On BDT 2007 nontourist Langrish singing The Littlest Hobo to the group from his commuter train home also deserves a special mention!



▶ **Watch:** Adam T – Never Mind The Drugs – The Song Doesn't Work!

As an aside, if you were wondering how on earth Adam T won the BDT 2021 prize when he didn't attend that tour to Celtic Manor, we were struggling to nominate a winner that year until Hursty spotted him putting in this performance, whilst on a site visit to Scarborough!

We look forward to seeing who will join the Elton Ravo roster in Scottsdale – Virgins, this is always one of the more straightforward trophies to win, so we expect great things!

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Charlie comfortably won the Elton Ravo for this performance of Gold.



▶ **Watch:** Charles Hadley in Action



Charlie Takes The Prize